

TUTORIAL 8 • THURSDAY 3 DECEMBER

Draft complete: from writer to editor

Read like a reviewer, edit top-down, and plan the road to 5 February

YOU LEAVE WITH

A complete first draft, a structured peer read using the four propositions, and your revision plan to 5 February.



Tutorial 8 of 8 • Semester 1

Today's plan

Goal: Leave with a complete draft, honest feedback on its structure, and a plan for the next nine weeks.

- 1 The 'hit-by-the-bus' moment: from writing to editing
- 2 Edit top-down: reverse-outline your own draft
- 3 Concision and precision: the January toolkit
- 4 Peer read: the four propositions
- 5 Your plan to 5 February

BRING / HAVE READY

- Your **complete first draft**, printed or as PDF (Task 7C)
- Two different-coloured pens
- Your workbook (revision plan page)



The ‘hit-by-the-bus’ moment

- Schultz's name for the point when a complete draft exists: if you were hit by a bus, someone could submit it.
- That's **today**. Many authors submit at this point. Schultz says that's the mistake.
- From now on your job changes from **writing** to **editing**: sentence structure, word choice, concision.
- Authors Schultz admires write **dozens of drafts**; ‘50 drafts would not be unreasonable’. You have nine weeks for three or four.
- And: **celebrate**. Schultz: reward yourself for milestones; ‘carrots generally work better than sticks’.

“

At the hit-by-the-bus moment, the role of the author must evolve from one dominated by writing to one dominated by editing.

— Schultz (2009), §13.1

Edit top-down: the writing funnel, then CPR



AT EACH SCALE: CPR (SCHALL, VIA SCHULTZ)

- **Concision:** trim what isn't needed.
- **Precision:** make what's left exact.
- **Revision:** sharpen the links between pieces.
- Work **down** the funnel. Fixing commas in a paragraph you then delete is wasted effort.
- Leave the draft alone for a **few days** first: Schultz's cure for being 'blinded to your own writing'.

IN-CLASS ACTIVITY • 5 MIN

Reverse-outline your own draft

- 1 In the margin beside **every paragraph**, write its job (context / problem / purpose / method / result / interpretation / limitation / answer) and its point in ≤ 6 words.
- 2 Read only the margin, top to bottom.
- 3 Mark: × a paragraph with **two jobs**; → one in the **wrong section**; ? a **missing step**.

YOU LEAVE WITH

- A structural to-do list for January, at the planetary and synoptic scales

WHY

- Schultz §13.2: 'label the topics of the text in the margins... The weaknesses in the organisation of the text will likely become apparent.'

Concision: the cheapest 200 words you'll ever cut

- Most first drafts over the limit are fixed by **concision**, not by cutting content.
- Schultz: applying his sentence-level advice can shorten drafts by **up to 20%** while making them clearer.
- **Précis**: rewrite a passage in the fewest words that keep every point. His example goes from 292 to 119 words.
- Search your draft for the phrases on the right. Most can simply go.

AVOID

USE

it can be seen that

(omit)

it should be noted that

(omit)

the results show that

(omit)

in order to

to

due to the fact that

because

a greater number of

more

in the vicinity of

near

is shown to be

is

utilise

use

(time) evolution · period (of time)

drop the brackets

How to give useful feedback

- Schultz: on an **early draft**, comment on the **biggest issues first**; don't line-edit sentences.
- Be **specific**: point at the paragraph and say what happened to you as a reader ('I lost the thread here').
- Say what **works** as well as what doesn't; the author needs to know what to keep.
- The most useful reviewers **challenge** you. Schultz: 'Least helpful are sycophants.'
- This is a **rehearsal for February**, when you swap your submitted drafts for peer feedback.

TODAY: STRUCTURE ONLY

No grammar, no spelling

Those are microscale. Today we're at the planetary and synoptic scales: question, answer, evidence, trust.

IN-CLASS ACTIVITY • 16 MIN

Peer read: the four propositions

- 1 Swap complete drafts. Read for **10 minutes**. Use the peer-read form in the workbook.
- 2 **Importance:** after the Introduction, write the author's question in your own words.
- 3 **Success:** does the Conclusion answer **that** question? Quote the sentence that does.
- 4 **Value:** name one figure or paragraph that could go, or say why none could.
- 5 **Competence:** one place where you doubted a method, number or claim. Then 6 minutes to talk it through.

YOU LEAVE WITH

- Four honest answers about your draft's structure
- The first entries on your personal weakness list

FOR THE AUTHOR

- If the reader's version of your question **differs** from yours, that's the most important feedback you'll get today.
- Don't argue: ask 'what made you think that?'

Your plan to 5 February

DECEMBER

Rest

Leave the draft alone for at least a week. Fresh eyes find more.

BY ~8 JAN

Pass 1: structure

Act on the reverse outline and peer read: sections and paragraphs.

BY ~22 JAN

Pass 2: CPR

Sentences and words: concision, precision, links. Get to $\leq 2,000$.

BY ~2 FEB

Pass 3: final checks

Run the final checklist on paper. Read it aloud once.

FRI 5 FEB

Submit the draft

Formative: no marks, no DASS extensions. Tutor confirms the method.

WHY PLAN NOW

- January is exam season: three short, scheduled passes beat one panicked weekend.
- **AI Minimal still applies** to every pass: grammar and spelling support only, on your own text. Keep dated versions.
- Then in semester 2: **peer feedback** (w/c 8 or 15 Feb) → **group presentation** (w/c 1 Mar) → **final report** (Fri 12 Mar, 12:00).

METHODS

Before you submit: robustness and reproducibility

- **Threshold:** ± 0.5 vs ± 1.0 °C.
- **Region:** shift the box by 5°.
- **One event:** leave out 2015–16. Is the signal still there?
- **Trend:** does removing a linear trend change your answer?
- **Significance:** using `n_eff`, or the shift test (methods_demos §7).
- **Reproducible:** record every setting (VARIABLE, ENSO_THRESH, CLIM_START/END, region bounds) so a classmate could remake each figure. Keep the notebook version you used.

ONE SENTENCE EACH, IN RESULTS OR DISCUSSION

“The sign and approximate size of the CP signal are unchanged when the 2015–16 event is excluded.”

“With a ± 1.0 °C threshold the MC composite weakens to [] pp but keeps its sign.”

(illustrative)

Final checks before you submit

- The question is in the **Introduction** and answered in **sentence 1 of the Conclusion**.
- **Consistent** terminology and tag-phrases; abbreviations defined at first use.
- Every figure **cited in order**, with a complete caption and **attribution**.
- Every citation is in the **reference list**, and every reference is cited; **ERA5 and ONI** cited.
- Every number has **units, baseline, period or n**; no unearned 'significant'.
- **≤ 2,000 words**; spelling/grammar checked; your **personal weakness list** checked.

SCHULTZ'S STOPPING RULE

"If you average one minor revision per page or less, then the manuscript is probably ready to submit. If you find yourself making a change during one round of revisions and undoing that change during the next round, submit the damn thing, will ya?"

END OF SEMESTER 1 WRITING STRAND

You've written a report. Now make it good.

See you in February with your draft, ready to swap.



Tutorial 8 of 8 · Semester 1